

Practical: Renaming a Table and Column in SQL Server

Aim: To rename an existing table and column using the sp_rename stored procedure.

Theory

The sp_rename stored procedure is used to rename database objects such as tables, columns, indexes, and constraints.

Syntax for Renaming a Table

```
EXEC sp_rename 'OldTableName', 'NewTableName';
```

Syntax for Renaming a Column

```
EXEC sp_rename 'TableName.OldColumnName', 'NewColumnName', 'COLUMN';
```

Question 1: Create an Employee Table

```
CREATE TABLE Employee ( EmpID INT PRIMARY KEY, EmpName VARCHAR(50), Salary  
DECIMAL(10,2) );
```

```
INSERT INTO Employee VALUES (101,'Rahul',25000), (102,'Priya',30000), (103,'Amit',28000);
```

```
SELECT * FROM Employee;
```

Question 2: Rename Employee Table to Employees

```
EXEC sp_rename 'Employee', 'Employees';
```

```
SELECT * FROM Employees;
```

Question 3: Rename Column EmpName to EmployeeName

```
EXEC sp_rename 'Employees.EmpName', 'EmployeeName', 'COLUMN';
```

```
SELECT * FROM Employees;
```

Question 4: Rename Column Salary to MonthlySalary

```
EXEC sp_rename 'Employees.Salary', 'MonthlySalary', 'COLUMN';
```

```
SELECT * FROM Employees;
```

Additional Example

```
CREATE TABLE Products ( ProductID INT, ProductName VARCHAR(50), Price DECIMAL(10,2) );
```

```
EXEC sp_rename 'Products', 'ProductDetails';
```

```
EXEC sp_rename 'ProductDetails.ProductName', 'ItemName', 'COLUMN';
```

Viva Questions and Answers

Q1. Which command is used to rename a table?

Ans: EXEC sp_rename 'OldTableName', 'NewTableName';

Q2. Which command is used to rename a column?

Ans: EXEC sp_rename 'TableName.OldColumnName', 'NewColumnName', 'COLUMN';

Q3. Does renaming affect existing data?

Ans: No, only the object name changes.

Q4. Can multiple columns be renamed?

Ans: Yes, one column at a time using sp_rename.

Q5. What is the purpose of the keyword COLUMN?

Ans: It tells SQL Server that the object being renamed is a column.

Result

Thus, the table Employee was successfully renamed to Employees, and the columns EmpName and Salary were successfully renamed using the sp_rename stored procedure.